# SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

**20 July 2022 · Shift 2**

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

## General English 25 questions

**Q.1**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Give someone a taste of their own medicine

**(A)** Sell something back to someone
**(B)** Mistreat someone in the same way they have treated others
**(C)** Show someone their faults
**(D)** Make fun of someone

**Q.2**

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Uttar Pradesh / accounts for about 16 per cent / of the / country population.

**(A)** of the
**(B)** country population
**(C)** Uttar Pradesh
**(D)** accounts for about 16 per cent

**Q.3**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We are _____ to the true legacy of humanism, and we must never forget this.

**(A)** Heirs
**(B)** Hair
**(C)** Hares
**(D)** Here

**Q.4**

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. You have to understood what normal political rhetoric looks like.

**(A)** understood what normal
**(B)** political rhetoric looks like
**(C)** No error
**(D)** You have to

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Community leaders were “baffled” by the sudden arrival of the President.

**(A)** flustered
**(B)** composed
**(C)** thwarted
**(D)** confused

**Q.6**

Select the option that rectifies the incorrectly spelt words in the given sentence. Our webcite is no longer avaialbale to the users.

**(A)** Our webcite is no longer available to the users.

**(B)** Our websight is no longer availbale to the users.

**(C)** Our website no longer available to the users.

**(D)** Our website is no longer availbale to the users.

**Q.7**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. I “has no doubts that there is a lesson” which stands to be learnt from Alice's misfortune.

**(A)** have no doubt that there is a lesson

**(B)** have had no doubts that their is a lesson

**(C)** am having no doubts that there are a lesson

**(D)** No improvement required

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. He was “on cloud nine” after passing the test.

**(A)** Very depressed

**(B)** Very happy

**(C)** Not educated

**(D)** Busy at work

**Q.9**

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Discrimination at the basis / of gender is not / acceptable in this office.

**(A)** of gender is not

**(B)** acceptable in this office

**(C)** No error

**(D)** Discrimination at the basis

**Q.10**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. Viren “examined careful” all the possibilities of data theft.

**(A)** carefully examined

**(B)** No improvement required

**(C)** examine careful

**(D)** careful examined

**Q.11**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The RTE Act bears many similarities to the US's No Child Left Behind Act, _____ school accountability, assessment standards and teacher training.

**(A)** startling

**(B)** responding

**(C)** including

**(D)** concluding

**Q.12**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I think it is quite _____ that your parents still hold hands.

**(A)** adorable

**(B)** adorably

**(C)** adore

**(D)** adores

**Q.13**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Slim

**(A)** Flashy

**(B)** Rosy

**(C)** Skinny

**(D)** Moody

**Q.14**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. You are not supposed "to touch these" books.

**(A)** off touching these
**(B)** No improvement required
**(C)** on touched that
**(D)** to touch this

**Q.15**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sporadic

**(A)** Infrequent
**(B)** Ample
**(C)** Methodical
**(D)** Regular

**Q.16**

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A game in which no one wins

**(A)** Hung
**(B)** Lapse
**(C)** Null
**(D)** Draw

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Evident

**(A)** Obvious
**(B)** Distinct
**(C)** Hidden
**(D)** Apparent

**Q.18**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The district "woken up to a" thick blanket of snow this morning as the winter entered its most bitter phase.

**(A)** wake up to a
**(B)** No improvement required
**(C)** awaken up to an
**(D)** woke up to a

**Q.19**

Select the correctly spelt word.

**(A)** Beneficial
**(B)** Benificial
**(C)** Beneifical
**(D)** Benificail

**Q.20**

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The community members as well as teachers "are presently into" the bus station.

**(A)** are presently on
**(B)** are present at
**(C)** No improvement required
**(D)** is present at

**Q.21**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Crosses, the village (1) _____ Vasili Andreevich lived, consisted of six houses. As soon as they had passed the blacksmith's hut, (2) _____ last in the village, they realised that the wind was much stronger than they had thought. The road could hardly be seen. The tracks left by the sledge-runners were immediately (3) _____ by snow and the road was only (4) _____ by the fact that it was higher than the rest of the ground. There was a swirl of snow over the fields and the line where sky and earth met could not be (5) _____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

**(A)** when
**(B)** we're
**(C)** where
**(D)** what

**Q.22**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Crosses, the village (1) _____ Vasili Andreevich lived, consisted of six houses. As soon as they had passed the blacksmith's hut, (2) _____ last in the village, they realised that the wind was much stronger than they had thought. The road could hardly be seen. The tracks left by the sledge-runners were immediately (3) _____ by snow and the road was only (4) _____ by the fact that it was higher than the rest of the ground. There was a swirl of snow over the fields and the line where sky and earth met could not be (5) _____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

**(A)** an
**(B)** the
**(C)** one
**(D)** a

**Q.23**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Crosses, the village (1) _____ Vasili Andreevich lived, consisted of six houses. As soon as they had passed the blacksmith's hut, (2) _____ last in the village, they realised that the wind was much stronger than they had thought. The road could hardly be seen. The tracks left by the sledge-runners were immediately (3) _____ by snow and the road was only (4) _____ by the fact that it was higher than the rest of the ground. There was a swirl of snow over the fields and the line where sky and earth met could not be (5) _____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

**(A)** exposed
**(B)** highlighted
**(C)** covered
**(D)** made

**Q.24**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Crosses, the village (1) _____ Vasili Andreevich lived, consisted of six houses. As soon as they had passed the blacksmith's hut, (2) _____ last in the village, they realised that the wind was much stronger than they had thought. The road could hardly be seen. The tracks left by the sledge-runners were immediately (3) _____ by snow and the road was only (4) _____ by the fact that it was higher than the rest of the ground. There was a swirl of snow over the fields and the line where sky and earth met could not be (5) _____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

**(A)** anguished
**(B)** distinguished
**(C)** crushed
**(D)** extinguished

**Q.25**

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Crosses, the village (1) _____ Vasili Andreevich lived, consisted of six houses. As soon as they had passed the blacksmith's hut, (2) _____ last in the village, they realised that the wind was much stronger than they had thought. The road could hardly be seen. The tracks left by the sledge-runners were immediately (3) _____ by snow and the road was only (4) _____ by the fact that it was higher than the rest of the ground. There was a swirl of snow over the fields and the line where sky and earth met could not be (5) _____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

**(A)** seen
**(B)** seeing
**(C)** saw
**(D)** see

## General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

**Q.3**

The scores of seven batsman B1, B2, B3, B4, B5, B6 and B7 are compared. The score of B1 is greater than B7 and B3. The score of B6 is neither more nor less than the score of B4 but more than B1. B5 scored less than only one batsman. The score of B7 is not the least score. How many batsman scored more than B4?

**(A)** 3
**(B)** 1
**(C)** 2
**(D)** 4

**Q.4**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All M are Q. II. No L is Q. Conclusions: I. No M is L. II. Some L are not M.

**(A)** Neither conclusion I nor II follows
**(B)** Both conclusions I and II follow
**(C)** Only conclusion II follows
**(D)** Only conclusion I follows

**Q.6**

Select the option that will replace the question mark (?) in the given series. 45, 35, 27, 21, 17, ?

**(A)** 14
**(B)** 13
**(C)** 15
**(D)** 16

**Q.7**

In a certain code language, 'Ashok is big' is written as 'pr 6 8', 'Huge people are strong' is written as 'lm pt 7 @' and 'Is big are' is written as 'pr pt 8'. What can be the possible code for 'Ashok people' in that code language?

**(A)** 6 pt
**(B)** 8 7
**(C)** 6 lm
**(D)** lm @

**Q.8**

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Cricket : Bat :: Hockey : Stick :: Rugby : ?

**(A)** Ball
**(B)** Goal
**(C)** Field
**(D)** Player

**Q.10**

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and fourth number is related to third number. 7 : 2401 :: 3 : 441 :: 5 : ?

**(A)** 685
**(B)** 880
**(C)** 1805
**(D)** 1225

**Q.11**

In a certain code language, 'nu vu du' is written as 'Please ask Hamza', 'hu du ru' is written as 'Give water please', and 'tu vu ru' is written as 'Give Hamza Book'. What is the code for the word 'Book' in that language?

**(A)** ru
**(B)** vu
**(C)** tu
**(D)** nu

**Q.12**

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. RBS : OXN :: OXA : ?

**(A)** LTW
**(B)** LUW
**(C)** LTV
**(D)** LUV

**Q.14**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given set. (131, 142, 153)

**(A)** (161, 172, 195)
**(B)** (119, 130, 141)
**(C)** (149, 160, 193)
**(D)** (127, 149, 160)

**Q.15**

After interchanging the given two signs, what will be the value of the given expression? ÷ and ×; 5 + 10 ÷ 8 × 2 – 20

**(A)** 25
**(B)** 30
**(C)** 20
**(D)** 35

**Q.16**

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. ACL, DFO, GIR, JLU, MOX, ?

**(A)** PRA
**(B)** NPZ
**(C)** OQZ
**(D)** ARP

**Q.17**

In a certain code language, 'ADULT' is coded as '53' and 'LACK' is coded as '23'. How will 'HEAVEN' be coded in that language?

**(A)** 58
**(B)** 55
**(C)** 49
**(D)** 61

**Q.18**

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All scales are pencils. Some pencils are erasers. Conclusions: I: Some scales are erasers. II: Some pencils are scales.

**(A)** Both I and II follow
**(B)** Only II follows
**(C)** Only I follows
**(D)** Neither I nor II follows

**Q.20**

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 81 + 31 ÷ 9 – 7 = 33

**(A)** 9 and 7
**(B)** 31 and 9
**(C)** 31 and 81
**(D)** 81 and 7

**Q.21**

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. SIDE22 : UKFG19 :: SETS15 : UGVU12 :: MINE11 : ?

**(A)** NJOF12
**(B)** OKPG8
**(C)** NJOF9
**(D)** OKPG14

**Q.22**

In a certain code language, 'sand is hot' is written as '6 8 9' and 'grains are white sand' is written as '4 3 9 2'. What is the code for 'hot' in that code language?

**(A)** 4
**(B)** 6 or 8
**(C)** 9
**(D)** 3

**Q.23**

Seven girls V, K, L, P, A, C and N are sitting in a row facing the South (not necessarily in the same order). L is to the immediate left of P. K is at one of the ends. A is the immediate neighbour of K. Only N is between A and C. Only P is between L and C. Which of the following statements is/are correct? I. P is third to the left of A. II. N is to the immediate right of C.

**(A)** Neither I nor II
**(B)** Only I
**(C)** Both I and II
**(D)** Only II

**Q.24**

Select the number from the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 482, 239, 158, 131, 122, ?

**(A)** 121
**(B)** 119
**(C)** 117
**(D)** 113

**Q.25**

Six friends Amit, Bhuvan, Chand, David, Emily and Fedrick are sitting around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Amit sits third to the left of David. David sits to the immediate right of Bhuvan. Bhuvan sits second to the left of Emily. Chand sits second to the right of Fedrick. Who sits second to the right of Amit?

**(A)** Chand
**(B)** Bhuvan
**(C)** Emily
**(D)** Fedrick

## General Awareness 25 questions

**Q.1**

Which of the following is an example of Phylum Mammalia of Animal Kingdom?

**(A)** Hen
**(B)** Crocodile
**(C)** Pigeon
**(D)** Rat

**Q.2**

As per the 2011 Census, arrange the following languages in descending order of Speakers strength: Marathi, Hindi, Maithili.

**(A)** Marathi, Hindi, Maithili
**(B)** Marathi, Maithili, Hindi
**(C)** Hindi, Maithili, Marathi
**(D)** Hindi, Marathi, Maithili

**Q.3**
Which Indian actress was also one of the dancer to be honoured with the 'Padma Shri' award in 1968?

**(A)** Hema Malini
**(B)** Sridevi
**(C)** Vyjayanthimala
**(D)** Madhubala

**Q.4**
In the northern and north-western part of India, _____ is the main food crop.

**(A)** Wheat
**(B)** Rice
**(C)** Maize
**(D)** millet

**Q.5**
Lavani is the dance form of which state?

**(A)** Gujarat
**(B)** Maharashtra
**(C)** Rajasthan
**(D)** Karnataka

**Q.6**
Which team won the Indian Super League 2021-22?

**(A)** Jamshedpur FC
**(B)** ATK Mohun Bagan
**(C)** Hyderabad FC
**(D)** Kerala Blasters FC

**Q.7**
The terminology ‘direct free kick’ is associated with which sport?

**(A)** Cricket
**(B)** Badminton
**(C)** Football
**(D)** Hockey

**Q.8**
Who among the following was conferred the Dadasaheb Phalke Award at the 67th National Film Awards ceremony?

**(A)** Sanjay Dutt
**(B)** S Shankar
**(C)** Rajinikanth
**(D)** Amitabh Bachchan

**Q.9**
In which of the following states of India is Gangaur festival celebrated?

**(A)** Manipur
**(B)** Rajasthan
**(C)** Karnataka
**(D)** Kerala

**Q.10**
In November 2021, ‘the Duare Ration’ scheme was launched in _____.

**(A)** Kerala
**(B)** Gujarat
**(C)** West Bengal
**(D)** Uttarakhand

**Q.11**
The Mahabodhi Temple is an ancient Buddhist temple. It is situated in which state of India?

**(A)** Rajasthan
**(B)** Uttar Pradesh
**(C)** Kerala
**(D)** Bihar

**Q.12**
Genghis Khan died in which year?

**(A)** 1227
**(B)** 1234
**(C)** 1222
**(D)** 1220

**Q.13**
Who among the following is the author of the book 'Selection Day'?

**(A)** Kiran Desai
**(B)** Vikram Seth
**(C)** Chetan Bhagat
**(D)** Aravind Adiga

**Q.14**
Who among the following freedom fighters was the first woman to become the Governor of Uttar Pradesh State?

**(A)** Sarojini Naidu
**(B)** Raikumari Amrit Kaur
**(C)** Sheila Dikshit
**(D)** Kasturba Gandhi

**Q.15**
The rhythmic rise and fall of ocean water twice in a day is called a _____.

**(A)** fall
**(B)** tide
**(C)** wave
**(D)** current

**Q.16**
What is the draft of legislative proposal that needs to be passed in both houses of Parliament of India to become an Act called?

**(A)** Article
**(B)** Amendment
**(C)** Bill
**(D)** Form

**Q.17**
_____ is the market value of all final goods and services produced within a domestic territory of a country measured in a year.

**(A)** Gross margin
**(B)** Gross Domestic Product (GDP)
**(C)** Net National Product (NNP)
**(D)** Gross National Product (GNP)

**Q.18**
Which of the following is a biotic component of ecology?

**(A)** Sunlight
**(B)** Carbonic substance
**(C)** Humidity
**(D)** Fungi

**Q.19**
With which of the following musical instruments was Ustad Alla Rakha primarily associated?

**(A)** Sitar
**(B)** Sarod
**(C)** Tabla
**(D)** Flute

**Q.20**
What is Brahmaputra River called in Arunachal Pradesh?

**(A)** Tsangpo
**(B)** Purab Ganga
**(C)** Dihang
**(D)** Mandakini

**Q.21**
Which feature of the Indian Constitution refers to the existence of more than one level of government in the country?

**(A)** Radicalism
**(B)** Federalism
**(C)** Liberalism
**(D)** Secularism

**Q.22**

Which of the following rulers did NOT belong to Maurya dynasty?

**(A)** Bindusara
**(B)** Ashoka
**(C)** Chandragupta
**(D)** Bimbisara

**Q.23**

Who among the following led of the famous Indigo Revolt in Bengal?

**(A)** Mahatma Gandhi
**(B)** Bishnu Charan Biswas and Digambar Biswas
**(C)** Vasudev Balwant Phadke
**(D)** Madari Pasi

**Q.24**

With respect to occupation, secondary activities include _____.

**(A)** mining
**(B)** administration
**(C)** construction work
**(D)** fishing

**Q.25**

Which of the following is an example of metalloid?

**(A)** Indium
**(B)** Gallium
**(C)** Boron
**(D)** Aluminium

# Answer key

### General English

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.2 **(B)** | Q.3 **(A)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(A)** | Q.8 **(B)** | Q.9 **(D)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(C)** | Q.12 **(A)** |
| Q.13 **(C)** | Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(A)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.18 **(D)** |
| Q.19 **(A)** | Q.20 **(B)** | Q.21 **(C)** | Q.22 **(B)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(B)** |
| Q.25 **(A)** | | | | | |

### General Intelligence and Reasoning

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(B)** | Q.6 **(C)** | Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(A)** | Q.10 **(D)** |
| Q.11 **(C)** | Q.12 **(C)** | Q.14 **(B)** | Q.15 **(A)** | Q.16 **(A)** | Q.17 **(C)** |
| Q.18 **(B)** | Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(B)** | Q.22 **(B)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(B)** |
| Q.25 **(B)** | | | | | |

### General Awareness

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(D)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(C)** |
| Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(C)** | Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.12 **(A)** |
| Q.13 **(D)** | Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(C)** | Q.17 **(B)** | Q.18 **(D)** |
| Q.19 **(C)** | Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(B)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(C)** |
| Q.25 **(C)** | | | | | |

## Explanations

### General English

**Q.1 · Answer (B) Mistreat someone in the same way they have treated others**

To give someone a taste of their own medicine is to treat them as badly as they have treated others.

**Q.2 · Answer (B) country population**

The noun 'country' must be possessive before 'population': 'of the country's population'.

**Q.3 · Answer (A) Heirs**

'Heirs' are those who inherit something, here the legacy of humanism. 'Hair', 'hares' and 'here' sound alike but do not fit.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) understood what normal**

After 'have to' the verb takes its base form: 'You have to understand what normal political rhetoric looks like.'

**Q.5 · Answer (B) composed**

'Baffled' means puzzled and confused; its opposite is 'composed', calm and in control. 'Flustered' and 'confused' are near synonyms, and 'thwarted' means prevented from doing something.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Our website no longer available to the users.**

SSC's key gives the only option that spells both 'website' and 'available' correctly; the others keep 'webcite', 'websight' or 'availbale'. As printed, the keyed option also leaves out 'is': the full correction is 'Our website is no longer available to the users.'

**Q.7 · Answer (A) have no doubt that there is a lesson**

The subject 'I' takes 'have', not 'has': 'I have no doubt that there is a lesson'. The other changes bring in new errors: 'their' for 'there', and 'there are a lesson'.

**Q.8 · Answer (B) Very happy**

To be 'on cloud nine' is to be extremely happy.

**Q.9 · Answer (D) Discrimination at the basis**

The phrase is 'on the basis of', not 'at the basis of': 'Discrimination on the basis of gender is not acceptable in this office.'

**Q.10 · Answer (A) carefully examined**

The verb 'examined' needs the adverb 'carefully', not the adjective 'careful': 'Viren carefully examined all the possibilities of data theft.'

**Q.11 · Answer (C) including**

'Including' introduces the examples of the similarities: school accountability, assessment standards and teacher training.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) adorable**

After 'it is quite' an adjective is needed: 'adorable', charming. 'Adorably' is an adverb, and 'adore' and 'adores' are verbs.

**Q.13 · Answer (C) Skinny**

'Slim' means thin, as does 'skinny'. 'Flashy' means showy, 'rosy' pink or hopeful and 'moody' given to changes of mood.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) No improvement required**

'Supposed to' is followed by the base verb, and the plural 'books' takes 'these', so the sentence is already correct.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) Infrequent**

'Sporadic' means happening now and then, at irregular intervals: 'infrequent'. 'Regular' and 'methodical' are nearly opposite, and 'ample' means plentiful.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) Draw**
A game that ends with no winner is a draw.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) Hidden**
'Evident' means plain to see; its opposite is 'hidden'. 'Obvious', 'distinct' and 'apparent' are near synonyms.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) woke up to a**
'This morning' places the action in the past, so the simple past 'woke' is needed: 'The district woke up to a thick blanket of snow'. 'Woken' is the past participle.

**Q.19 · Answer (A) Beneficial**
The correct spelling is 'beneficial'.

**Q.20 · Answer (B) are present at**
Being at a place is 'present at', and the subject 'the community members' stays plural ('as well as teachers' does not change it), so 'are present at the bus station'.

**Q.21 · Answer (C) where**
'Where' introduces a place: the village in which Vasili Andreevich lived.

**Q.22 · Answer (B) the**
The hut was a particular one, the last in the village, so it takes 'the'.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) covered**
The sledge tracks were immediately 'covered' by the snow, which is why the road could hardly be seen.

**Q.24 · Answer (B) distinguished**
The road could be 'distinguished', told apart from the fields, only because it was higher than the rest of the ground.

**Q.25 · Answer (A) seen**
'Could not be' takes the past participle in the passive: 'could not be seen'.

### General Intelligence and Reasoning

**Q.3 · Answer (C) 2**
B6 and B4 are equal and both beat B1, which beats B7 and B3. B5 is beaten by only one batsman, so it must be above B6 and B4 (else both would beat it), and the one above it is B2. With B3 last (B7 is not), the order is B2, B5, B6 = B4, B1, B7, B3: two batsmen scored more than B4.

**Q.4 · Answer (B) Both conclusions I and II follow**
Every M is a Q and no L is a Q, so no M is L (I). As no L is an M, some L are not M (II) follows too.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) 15**
The differences are −10, −8, −6, −4, so the next is −2: 17 − 2 = 15.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) 6 lm**
'Is big' is common to the first and third sentences (pr, 8), so 'Ashok' is 6; 'are' is common to the second and third (pt), so 'people' is lm, 7 or @. Only '6 lm' can be the code.

**Q.8 · Answer (A) Ball**
Cricket is played with a bat and hockey with a stick; rugby is played with a ball.

**Q.10 · Answer (D) 1225**
The second number is the square of 7 times the first: $(7 \times 7)^2 = 2401$ and $(3 \times 7)^2 = 441$. So $(5 \times 7)^2 = 35^2 = 1225$.

**Q.11 · Answer (C) tu**
'Please' is common to the first two sentences (du), 'Hamza' to the first and third (vu) and 'Give' to the last two (ru), so 'Book' is tu.

**Q.12 · Answer (C) LTV**
The letters move back 3, 4 and 5: R → O, B → X, S → N. So O → L, X → T, A → V: LTV.

**Q.14 · Answer (B) (119, 130, 141)**
Each number is 11 more than the one before: 131, 142, 153. Likewise 119, 130, 141.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) 25**
After interchanging ÷ and ×: 5 + 10 × 8 ÷ 2 – 20 = 5 + 40 – 20 = 25.

**Q.16 · Answer (A) PRA**
Each letter moves 3 places forward: A, D, G, J, M, P; C, F, I, L, O, R; L, O, R, U, X, A (wrapping round after Z). The next cluster is PRA.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) 49**
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet minus the number of letters: ADULT = 1 + 4 + 21 + 12 + 20 – 5 = 53 and LACK = 12 + 1 + 3 + 11 – 4 = 23. So HEAVEN = 8 + 5 + 1 + 22 + 5 + 14 – 6 = 49.

**Q.18 · Answer (B) Only II follows**
Every scale is a pencil, so some pencils are scales (II). The pencils that are erasers need not include any scale, so I does not follow.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) 31 and 81**
Interchanging 31 and 81: 31 + 81 ÷ 9 – 7 = 31 + 9 – 7 = 33.

**Q.21 · Answer (B) OKPG8**
Each letter moves 2 places forward and the number falls by 3: SIDE22 → UKFG19 and SETS15 → UGVU12. So MINE11 → OKPG8.

**Q.22 · Answer (B) 6 or 8**
'Sand' is common to both sentences, so it is 9; 'is' and 'hot' share 6 and 8, so 'hot' is 6 or 8.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) Both I and II**
Taking the girls' own left and right: L, P and C sit together in that order, N is the only one between C and A (A cannot be on P's side), and K, at an end, sits next to A. From their left: V, L, P, C, N, A, K. P is third to the left of A and N is immediately to the right of C, so both are correct.

**Q.24 · Answer (B) 119**
The differences are –243, –81, –27, –9, each a third of the one before, so the next is –3: 122 – 3 = 119.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) Bhuvan**
Going round to the right: Bhuvan, David, Emily, Fedrick, Amit, Chand. Amit sits opposite David (third to his left), and Chand, second to the right of Fedrick, takes the last seat. Second to the right of Amit is Bhuvan.

### General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (D) Rat**
A rat is a mammal: it has hair and feeds its young on milk. The hen and pigeon are birds and the crocodile a reptile. (Mammalia is strictly a class of the phylum Chordata, not a phylum.)

**Q.2 · Answer (D) Hindi, Marathi, Maithili**
In the 2011 Census Hindi had about 52.8 crore speakers (43.6% of the population), Marathi about 8.3 crore (6.9%) and Maithili about 1.4 crore (1.1%).

**Q.3 · Answer (C) Vyjayanthimala**
Vyjayanthimala, the Bharatanatyam dancer and Hindi and Tamil film actress, received the Padma Shri in 1968.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Wheat**
NCERT calls wheat, the second most important cereal crop, the main food crop of the north and north-western part of the country.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) Maharashtra**
Lavani is a song-and-dance form of Maharashtra, performed to the beat of the dholki.

**Q.6 · Answer (C) Hyderabad FC**
Hyderabad FC won the 2021-22 Indian Super League, beating Kerala Blasters on penalties in the final in March 2022.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) Football**
In football a direct free kick, given for fouls such as tripping or handling the ball, can be scored straight from the kick. Hockey has free hits rather than free kicks.

**Q.8 · Answer (C) Rajinikanth**
Rajinikanth received the Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2019 at the 67th National Film Awards ceremony in New Delhi in October 2021.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) Rajasthan**
Gangaur, held in honour of the goddess Gauri (Parvati), is a major festival of Rajasthan, celebrated mainly by women.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) West Bengal**
West Bengal's Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee launched 'Duare Ration' (ration at the doorstep), which delivers ration to people's homes, on 16 November 2021.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) Bihar**
The Mahabodhi Temple at Bodh Gaya, Bihar, stands where the Buddha is believed to have attained enlightenment; it is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

**Q.12 · Answer (A) 1227**
Genghis Khan, founder of the Mongol Empire, died in August 1227.

**Q.13 · Answer (D) Aravind Adiga**
'Selection Day' (2016), a novel about two brothers groomed to become cricketers in Mumbai, is by Aravind Adiga, the author of 'The White Tiger'.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) Sarojini Naidu**
Sarojini Naidu became Governor of the United Provinces (now Uttar Pradesh) in August 1947, the first woman governor of an Indian state, and held the post until her death in March 1949.

**Q.15 · Answer (B) tide**
A tide is the regular rise and fall of the sea, caused mainly by the Moon's pull, about twice a day.

**Q.16 · Answer (C) Bill**
A legislative proposal is a Bill; once both Houses pass it and the President assents, it becomes an Act.

**Q.17 · Answer (B) Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**
GDP is the market value of all final goods and services produced within a country's domestic territory in a year. GNP adds net factor income from abroad, and NNP subtracts depreciation from GNP.

**Q.18 · Answer (D) Fungi**
Fungi are living organisms (decomposers), so they are a biotic component; sunlight and humidity are abiotic factors.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Tabla**
Ustad Alla Rakha, father of Zakir Hussain, was a celebrated tabla player who often accompanied Ravi Shankar.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) Dihang**
The Brahmaputra is the Tsangpo in Tibet; it enters India in Arunachal Pradesh, where it is called the Dihang (or Siang), and becomes the Brahmaputra in Assam after the Dibang and Lohit join it.

**Q.21 · Answer (B) Federalism**
Federalism means power is shared between more than one level of government: in India, the Union, the states and local governments.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) Bimbisara**
Bimbisara was a ruler of Magadha of the Haryanka dynasty, before the Mauryas. Chandragupta founded the Maurya dynasty, and Bindusara and Ashoka followed him.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) Bishnu Charan Biswas and Digambar Biswas**
The Indigo Revolt of 1859-60 began in Nadia district of Bengal, where Bishnu Charan Biswas and Digambar Biswas led the cultivators against the European planters who forced them to grow indigo.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) construction work**
Secondary activities process raw materials into goods or build things, as in manufacturing and construction. Mining and fishing are primary activities and administration a tertiary one.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) Boron**
Boron is a metalloid, with properties between those of metals and non-metals. Aluminium, gallium and indium, below it in group 13, are metals.

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